

FILM

IT Chapter 2

★★★★☆ | Dreary, slow-paced and not all that scary, you know a horror film has failed to materialise as a good one when it ticks all the aforementioned adjectives. Unfortunately, Andrés Muschietti's IT Chapter 2 does just this, which is a sore disappointment after the much-acclaimed IT (2017).

The film kicks off 27 years after 'Losers' of Derry a.k.a. the bunch of kids, portrayed by extremely talented young actors, took up arms against the evil entity masquerading around the town as the clown "Pennywise", going about gobbling up innocent children. The 'Losers' defeated Pennywise in IT 2017 and vowed to come back to Derry if Pennywise returned.

You have all your classic characters roles here - Beverly (Jessica Chastain),



the only woman in the group who is "the one who got away". From who, you ask? Well, there are characters who make up the classic love triangle including Bill (James McAvoy), the nervous, stuttering boy-turned-man who lost his brother to It in the first movie, and Ben (Jay Ryan) the new (overweight) kid on the block who's now turned into a gorgeous man.

Bill Skarsgård is absolutely brilliant as Pennywise and can transform from innocent to terrifying in seconds. His laugh, dialogue delivery and expressions were spot on during the entire movie.

One of the most crucial elements which was also a saving grace for the film was the comedy. Yes, the movie is absolutely hilarious and even some of the "scary" scenes caused the audience to giggle instinctively owing to the overwhelmingly comic nature of the first act. While comedy may have played a part in taking away the sheer horror of the film, it managed to breathe life into it and hold on to the slipping attention of the audience.

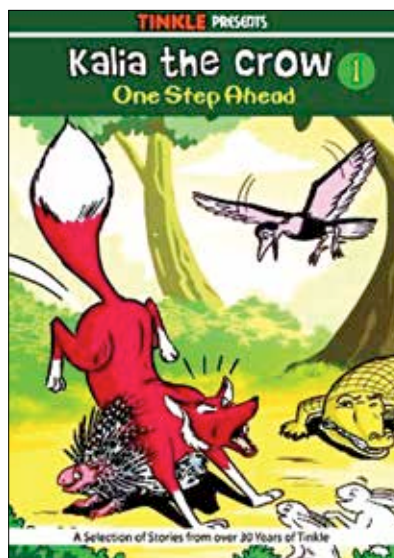
It (2017) was a coming of age film that used the plot of Pennywise and defeating him as a metaphor for growing up and losing your innocence, however, with the characters all grown up there are fewer ramifications of such kind.

While IT Chapter 2 definitely held promise, especially with the stellar first act of the film that broke the bounds of horror film clichés, the laboriously long preamble to the final act and the disappointing, emotionally-empty final act desecrate what could have been a fantastic sequel.

COMIC

Kalia the crow

★★★★☆ | There seem to be so many Tinkle volumes apart from the main comics, that it is difficult to make sense of all of it. First, there are the Tinkle comics themselves, the Tinkle Digests and the Double Digests. Then there are Tinkle Origins and the Essentials Collections. While Origins have the earliest stories featuring popular characters, the Essentials Collections have stories from all time periods. Then there is Tinkle Presents, which is available directly from Amar Chitra Katha as half yearly "Toons" subscriptions. Apart from the Origins, the Tinkle Presents series really stand out, if you want to keep getting regular and periodic doses of material with your favourite characters. While you never know what you are going to get with the Toons subscription, you can purchase individual volumes from Amazon



or Flipkart, although they tend to sell out very quickly. The volumes are not individually available from ACK or Tinkle's web store.

Out of all these, Kaalia the Crow - 1 is really a stand out. There is story after story of the crow outfoxing Chama-taka, the jackal and his friend Doob Doob, the crocodile, as they try all

kinds of tricks to capture the two rabbits, Keechu and Meechu, or occasionally Shonar, the deer. All the stories are reminiscent of Brer Rabbit, only the schemes of Kaalia the crow are just much more smarter. Tinkle Presents has a collection of stories, but they are not the earliest versions with noticeably different art work from the Origins series, nor the more modern and contemporary stories seen in the main series of comics, with its agenda of having a more diverse representation of woodland creatures for a new generation of young readers. This is Kaalia the Crow at his best, and most recognisable. At times, there are some adventures that parallel old fables, and at other times Kaalia may leave the familiar jungle and take a trip up north, where he meets a snow leopard. The artwork and storytelling are likely to be the most familiar to those who read Tinkle in the late 90s and early 2000s. This is a solid single volume to buy, and much cheaper than Origins. The best option is to just subscribe to Tinkle Toons.